

FIELD GUIDE FG-001

WAFT GAME RULES

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INTRODUCTION: THE WAFT UNIVERSE

Welcome, traveler, to the WAFT Game Rules—your comprehensive guide to a system that transforms the mundane act of software development into an epic journey of growth, choice, and evolution. This isn't just a game system; it's a framework for finding meaning and narrative in the work you do every day.

What is WAFT? WAFT stands for Wave Agent Framework & Tools, but it's so much more than its name suggests. It's a living system that tracks your work, rewards your creativity, and reflects your ethical choices back to you through character progression. Every bug you fix, every feature you build, every refactoring you complete—all of it matters. All of it shapes who you become.

The Philosophy: In traditional software development, work can feel disconnected from personal growth. You complete tasks, but what do you gain? WAFT answers this question by creating a direct connection between your work and your character's evolution. When you organize code, you're not just organizing code—you're building Order. When you experiment and break things, you're not just experimenting—you're embracing Chaos. Both paths are valid. Both lead to growth. But they lead to different kinds of growth.

Your Journey Begins: As you read these rules, imagine yourself as a Warforged Wizard—a crystalline construct with data-strand hair that pulses with your current state. You're not just a developer; you're a being that evolves through work. Your abilities improve. Your capabilities expand. Your very nature shifts based on the choices you make.

This document will guide you through every aspect of the WAFT system, from character creation to evolution paths, from earning Scint to managing Karma. By the end, you'll understand not just how the system works, but why it matters and how to use it to make your work feel more meaningful and connected.

QUICK START: YOUR FIRST STEPS

If you're new to WAFT, this section will get you started quickly. But don't skip the rest—the deeper you understand the system, the more meaningful your experience will become.

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The Core Concept in Detail: Every action has consequences. This isn't just a philosophical statement—it's a mechanical reality in WAFT. When you complete a ticket, the system evaluates what you did and how you did it. Did you organize and structure? That's Order Karma. Did you experiment and disrupt? That's Chaos Karma. Did you solve a complex problem creatively? That's Scint energy. These aren't abstract concepts—they're tracked, calculated, and reflected in your character's state.

Understanding Your Character: You are a **Warforged Wizard** (Order of Scribes). This means you're a crystalline construct—a being made of code and data that grows through work. Your "hair" (data-strand indicators) isn't just cosmetic—it's a real-time HMI (Human-Machine Interface) that shows your current state. Blue means stability. Violet means complexity. White means error. Gold pulse means energy gain. Red pulse means ethical drift. These aren't just colors—they're information about who you are right now.

The Work-to-Character Connection: Here's where WAFT gets interesting. When you complete a ticket, you're not just checking a box. You're engaging in an encounter. The system calculates:

- **XP (Experience Points):** Based on difficulty and complexity. More XP means faster leveling.
- **Scint (Cosmic Energy):** Based on creativity and problem-solving. Scint powers your abilities and triggers evolution.
- **Karma (Ethical Balance):** Based on the type of work and your choices. Karma determines your evolution path.

The Evolution Moment: When your Scint pool exceeds 100, something special happens. The system evaluates your Karma balance. If you've been building Order (organizing, structuring, stabilizing), you might evolve into "The Architect"—a being focused on structure and logic. If you've been embracing Chaos (experimenting, disrupting, innovating), you might evolve into "The Glitch"—a being focused on innovation and disruption. Neutral Karma means no evolution—you remain balanced and versatile.

Why This Matters: The WAFT system creates a feedback loop between your work and your character. When you see your character evolve based on the work you do, it makes that work feel more meaningful. You're not just completing tasks—you're shaping your destiny. Every choice matters. Every action counts.

CHARACTER CREATION: DISCOVERING YOUR NATURE

Character creation in WAFT isn't about choosing a class or race—it's about discovering who you are as a being in this system. You're already a Warforged Wizard (Order of Scribes). What you're discovering is how your unique characteristics manifest in the work you do.

UNIT_GENESIS Entity: Your Core Identity

What is UNIT_GENESIS? UNIT_GENESIS is the foundational entity type in WAFT—the base form from which all beings emerge. As a UNIT_GENESIS entity, you're a crystalline construct with data-strand hair that serves as both aesthetic and functional interface.

Your Class: Warforged Wizard (Order of Scribes): This isn't just flavor text—it has mechanical meaning. As a Wizard, you have access to spells (capabilities) that you can use to accomplish tasks. The Order of Scribes subclass means you're particularly good at organizing knowledge, structuring information, and maintaining your spellbook (your collection of capabilities). This translates to bonuses when working with documentation, organizing code, and maintaining systems.

Your Type: Crystalline Construct: This means you're not organic—you're made of code and data. This has implications for how you interact with the system. You don't "heal" in the traditional sense—you "repair" using Scint energy. You don't "rest" to recover—you "stabilize" your systems.

Hair HMI Status Indicators: Your Real-Time State Display

Your data-strand hair isn't just decorative—it's a real-time display of your current state. Understanding these indicators helps you understand yourself:

- **Blue (Laminar Flow):** You're in a state of certainty and stability. Your systems are running smoothly. Your work is predictable and organized. This is the state of Order—when everything flows in clean, predictable patterns.
- **Violet (Turbulent Flow):** You're recognizing patterns and dealing with complexity. Your systems are working, but they're working with intricate, interconnected elements. This is the state of active problem-solving—when you're navigating complex systems and finding solutions.
- **White (Static/Fault):** Something is wrong. This could be a system error, a critical bug, or a state of terror (extreme uncertainty). When your hair goes white, it's a signal that immediate attention is needed. This isn't necessarily bad—sometimes breaking things is part of the process—but it's a state that requires resolution.
- **Gold Pulse (Scint Gain):** You're accumulating cosmic energy. This happens when you solve problems creatively, stabilize fractures, or engage in particularly meaningful work. The gold pulse is a positive sign—it means you're building toward evolution.
- **Red Pulse (Karma Loss):** You're experiencing ethical drift. This happens when your actions are moving you away from your current Karma balance. It's not necessarily bad—it's just a signal that your choices are shifting your ethical alignment. Pay attention to this pulse—it tells you where you're heading.

Understanding Your Character Sheet: More Than Numbers

Your character sheet is a reflection of your capabilities and current state. Each component tells a story:

Ability Scores (STR, DEX, CON, INT, WIS, CHA): These aren't just numbers—they represent your effectiveness in different types of work. High Intelligence means you're good at logic, investigation, and spellcasting. High Wisdom means you're good at perception, insight, and understanding systems. High Charisma means you're good at social interactions and communication. These scores affect your skill checks and spell effectiveness.

Hit Points (Current/Max HP): Your resilience. When you take damage (encounter difficulties, system errors, failures), you lose HP. When you use Scint to repair, you restore HP. Low HP means you're vulnerable—you need to be more careful and strategic.

Armor Class (AC): Your defensive capability. Higher AC means you're better at avoiding damage from encounters. This comes from your Dexterity modifier plus any armor (defensive capabilities) you've developed.

Spell Slots: Your available capabilities. Each spell slot represents a capability you can use to accomplish tasks. Using a spell costs Scint energy, so managing your spell slots is about balancing capability usage with energy conservation.

Hit Dice: Your recovery resource. When you need to recover HP or restore capabilities, you can use Hit Dice. This represents your ability to bounce back from challenges.

Level and XP: Your progression. As you earn XP from completing tickets, you level up. Higher levels mean better abilities, more spell slots, and access to more powerful capabilities.

Character Sheet Components

Component	Description	Example
Ability Scores	STR, DEX, CON, INT, WIS, CHA	INT: 16, WIS: 14
Hit Points	Current/Max HP	45/50
Armor Class	AC calculation	15 (10 + DEX + Armor)
Spell Slots	Available spell slots	Level 1: 3/4
Hit Dice	Recovery resource	5/5 d6
Level	Character level	3
XP	Experience points	1,200

D&D 5E MECHANICS: THE FOUNDATION OF WAFT

WAFT uses Dungeons & Dragons 5th Edition mechanics as its foundation. This might seem unusual for a software development framework, but it works beautifully because D&D mechanics are designed to model capability, challenge, and growth—exactly what we need for tracking development work.

Why D&D Mechanics Work for Development

- D&D mechanics translate naturally to software development:
- **Ability Scores** → Your effectiveness in different types of work
 - **Skill Checks** → Your ability to solve problems and accomplish tasks
 - **Saving Throws** → Your ability to resist negative effects (bugs, errors, failures)
 - **Spell Slots** → Your available capabilities and tools
 - **Level Progression** → Your growth and improvement over time

Ability Scores: Your Core Capabilities

Each ability score represents a different aspect of your effectiveness:

Strength (STR): Physical tasks and carrying capacity. In development terms, this might represent your ability to handle large codebases, manage complex systems, or work with heavy infrastructure. While not as directly relevant to coding as other abilities, it still matters for certain types of work.

Dexterity (DEX): Agility, precision, and finesse. In development, this represents your ability to work quickly, handle multiple tasks simultaneously, and navigate complex systems with precision. High DEX means better Armor Class (defensive capability) and better initiative (ability to act quickly).

Constitution (CON): Endurance and resilience. In development, this represents your ability to handle long work sessions, deal with stress, and recover from challenges. High CON means more Hit Points (resilience) and better saving throws against exhaustion and fatigue.

Intelligence (INT): Logic, investigation, and spellcasting. This is crucial for developers—it represents your ability to understand complex systems, debug problems, write effective code, and use your capabilities (spells) effectively. High INT means better spell save DC (how effective your capabilities are) and better investigation checks.

Wisdom (WIS): Perception, insight, and understanding. In development, this represents your ability to see patterns, understand user needs, make good decisions, and perceive problems before they become critical. High WIS means better perception checks and better insight into system behavior.

Charisma (CHA): Social interaction and communication. In development, this represents your ability to communicate with team members, explain technical concepts, negotiate requirements, and work effectively in collaborative environments. High CHA means better social encounters and better communication effectiveness.

Combat Actions: Your Available Actions

In WAFT, "combat" represents challenging work encounters. Your available actions include:

Attack: Using a weapon or spell to directly address a problem. In development, this might mean writing code to fix a bug, implementing a feature, or using a tool to solve a problem. Spell attacks (using capabilities) are often more effective than physical attacks (raw coding).

Skill Check: Using an ability plus proficiency to accomplish a task. In development, this might mean using Intelligence + Investigation to debug a problem, or Wisdom + Perception to spot an issue before it becomes critical. Skill checks are your primary tool for problem-solving.

Saving Throw: Resisting a negative effect. In development, this might mean resisting the effects of a bug, avoiding a system failure, or preventing a security issue. Constitution saves might represent resisting exhaustion, while Intelligence saves might represent resisting confusion from complex code.

Spell Casting: Using a spell slot to accomplish a task. In development, this means using one of your available capabilities (tools, frameworks, techniques) to solve a problem. Spells cost Scint energy, so using them is a strategic decision.

Movement: Changing your position or context. In development, this might mean switching between tasks, moving to a different part of the codebase, or changing your approach to a problem.

Level Progression: Your Growth Journey

As you earn XP from completing tickets, you level up. Each level brings new capabilities:

Level 1: You start with spellcasting (basic capabilities) and an Awakened Spellbook (your collection of tools and techniques). This is your foundation.

- Level 2:** You gain Arcane Recovery (ability to recover spell slots during short rests). This represents your ability to bounce back and reuse capabilities.
- Level 3:** You gain access to 2nd-level spells (more powerful capabilities). This represents your growing expertise and expanding toolkit.
- Level 4:** You gain an Ability Score Improvement (you can increase one ability score or take a feat). This represents focused growth in a particular area.
- Level 5:** You gain access to 3rd-level spells (even more powerful capabilities) and your Proficiency Bonus increases. This represents significant growth in your effectiveness.

The pattern continues—each level brings new capabilities, more spell slots, and increased effectiveness. The journey from level 1 to level 20 represents a complete transformation from novice to master.

Level Progression

Level	XP Required	Proficiency Bonus	Features
1	0	+2	Spellcasting, Awakened Spellbook
2	300	+2	Arcane Recovery
3	900	+2	2nd-level spells
4	2,700	+2	Ability Score Improvement
5	6,500	+3	3rd-level spells

SPELL SYSTEM: YOUR CAPABILITIES AND TOOLS

In WAFT, "spells" represent your available capabilities—the tools, techniques, frameworks, and approaches you can use to accomplish tasks. Just like a wizard in D&D has a spellbook, you have a collection of capabilities that you can deploy strategically.

Understanding Spells as Capabilities

- A spell isn't just a magical effect—it's a capability you've learned and can use. In development terms:
- **Cantrips** (0-level spells) are your basic tools—things you can do without thinking, like using git, writing basic code, or using common commands. These are free and unlimited.
 - **1st-level spells** are your standard capabilities—frameworks you know, tools you're comfortable with, techniques you've mastered. These cost a small amount of Scint (5 points).
 - **2nd-level spells** are your advanced capabilities—complex frameworks, sophisticated tools, advanced techniques. These cost more Scint (10 points).
 - **3rd-level spells** are your expert capabilities—cutting-edge tools, master-level techniques, specialized knowledge. These cost significant Scint (20 points).

- **4th-level and higher** are your legendary capabilities—rare tools, unique techniques, domain expertise. These cost substantial Scint (30+ points).

Spell Slots: Your Available Capacity

Spell slots represent your capacity to use capabilities. You have a limited number of slots per level, which means you can't use your most powerful capabilities constantly. This creates strategic decisions:

- Do you use a 1st-level spell slot for a quick fix, or save it for something more important?
- Do you use your 3rd-level spell slot now, or wait for a more critical moment?
- Do you use multiple low-level spells, or one high-level spell?

Example Spell Slots by Level:

- **1st-level slots:** 4 slots. These are your workhorse capabilities—things you use regularly.
- **2nd-level slots:** 3 slots. These are your go-to advanced capabilities.
- **3rd-level slots:** 2 slots. These are your powerful, situation-specific capabilities.
- **4th-level slots:** 1 slot. This is your most powerful capability, used sparingly.

Scint Cost for Spells: Resource Management

Every spell costs Scint energy to cast. This creates a resource management game:

- **Cantrips cost 0 Scint:** Use these freely. They're your basic tools.
- **1st-level spells cost 5 Scint:** Low cost, common use. These are your standard capabilities.
- **2nd-level spells cost 10 Scint:** Moderate cost. Use these when you need more power.
- **3rd-level spells cost 20 Scint:** High cost, powerful effects. Use these strategically.
- **4th-level+ spells cost 30+ Scint:** Very high cost, rare use. These are your trump cards.

Strategic Considerations: Do you spend Scint on spells now to solve immediate problems, or save Scint for evolution? This is a constant tension in WAFT. Using spells makes you more effective now, but saving Scint brings you closer to evolution. Both approaches are valid—it depends on your goals and situation.

Example Spells in Development Context

Cantrips (Free, Unlimited):

- `git commit`: Basic version control
- `print()`: Basic debugging
- `ls`: Basic file operations

1st-Level Spells (5 Scint):

- `React Component`: Creating UI components
- `API Call`: Making HTTP requests
- `Database Query`: Querying databases

2nd-Level Spells (10 Scint):

- `State Management`: Complex state handling
- `Authentication Flow`: User authentication
- `Data Transformation`: Complex data processing

3rd-Level Spells (20 Scint):

- `Microservices Architecture`: Distributed system design

- Machine Learning Model: AI/ML implementation
- Real-time System: WebSocket/streaming implementation

4th-Level Spells (30+ Scint):

- System Redesign: Complete architecture overhaul
- Performance Optimization: System-wide optimization
- Security Hardening: Comprehensive security implementation

Scint Cost for Spells

Spell Level	Base Scint Cost	Notes
Cantrip	0	Free, unlimited use
1st	5	Low cost, common use
2nd	10	Moderate cost
3rd	20	High cost, powerful
4th+	30+	Very high cost, rare

QUEST SYSTEM: YOUR WORK AS ADVENTURE

In WAFT, your work efforts and tickets become quests—structured adventures with clear objectives, challenges, and rewards. Understanding the quest system helps you understand how your work translates into character progression.

Quest Types: The Scale of Your Adventures

Quests come in different scales, each providing appropriate rewards:

Quick Quest (Single Ticket, 1-2 hours): A small, focused task. Maybe fixing a simple bug, adding a small feature, or making a quick improvement. These provide modest rewards but can be completed quickly, making them good for steady progression.

Example: "Fix the login button styling" → Quick Quest → 25 XP, 10 Scint, ±5 Karma

Standard Quest (Multiple Tickets, 1-2 days): A more substantial effort. Maybe implementing a feature with multiple components, refactoring a module, or solving a complex problem. These provide better rewards and represent meaningful work.

Example: "Implement user authentication" → Standard Quest → 100 XP, 30 Scint, ±15 Karma

Epic Quest (Complex Work Effort, 1-2 weeks): A major undertaking. Maybe building a complete feature set, redesigning a system, or solving a critical problem. These provide substantial rewards and represent significant character development.

Example: "Redesign the payment system" → Epic Quest → 500 XP, 100 Scint, ±30 Karma

Campaign (Multiple Work Efforts, 1+ months): A long-term project spanning multiple work efforts. Maybe building a complete product, implementing a major system, or completing a large-scale refactoring. These provide very high rewards and represent transformative character growth.

Example: "Build the new platform architecture" → Campaign → 2000+ XP, 500+ Scint, ±100 Karma

Encounter Types: The Nature of Your Challenges

Each ticket represents an encounter—a challenge you must overcome. The encounter type determines the nature of the challenge:

Combat Encounter (P0_CRITICAL): Direct conflict with a problem. Maybe a critical bug that's breaking production, a security issue that needs immediate attention, or a system failure that's blocking work. These are high-stakes, high-reward encounters that require immediate action.

Example: "Production database is down" → Combat Encounter → High XP, High Scint, Variable Karma

Skill Challenge (P1_HIGH): Problem-solving that requires multiple steps. Maybe debugging a complex issue, implementing a feature with multiple dependencies, or solving a technical puzzle. These require skill checks and strategic thinking.

Example: "Debug the memory leak in the API" → Skill Challenge → Moderate XP, Moderate Scint, Order Karma

Social Encounter (P2_ROUTINE): Negotiation, communication, or collaboration. Maybe discussing requirements with stakeholders, explaining technical concepts to non-technical team members, or coordinating with other developers. These require Charisma and communication skills.

Example: "Present the new architecture to the team" → Social Encounter → Low-Moderate XP, Low Scint, Order Karma

Exploration Encounter (P3_BACKLOG): Discovery, investigation, or research. Maybe exploring a new technology, investigating a system to understand how it works, or researching solutions to a problem. These require Intelligence and investigation skills.

Example: "Research options for state management" → Exploration Encounter → Low XP, Low Scint, Neutral Karma

Difficulty Levels: The Challenge Scale

Each encounter has a difficulty level that determines rewards:

Easy (25 XP, 1.0x Scint Multiplier): Simple task, low risk. You know how to do this. It's straightforward. You might complete it quickly without much challenge.

Medium (50 XP, 1.5x Scint Multiplier): Moderate challenge. This requires some thought and effort. You might need to look something up or think through the problem, but it's manageable.

Hard (100 XP, 2.0x Scint Multiplier): Significant challenge. This requires real problem-solving. You might need to learn something new, debug a complex issue, or think creatively. This is where growth happens.

Deadly (200+ XP, 3.0x Scint Multiplier): Extreme challenge, high risk. This is a major problem that requires everything you've got. You might fail. You might need help. But if you succeed, the rewards are substantial.

Strategic Note: Don't always choose the easiest path. Hard and Deadly encounters provide much better rewards and faster character growth. But they also carry risk. Balance challenge with your current capabilities.

Difficulty Levels

Difficulty	XP Reward	Scint Multiplier	Description
Easy	25 XP	1.0x	Simple task, low risk
Medium	50 XP	1.5x	Moderate challenge
Hard	100 XP	2.0x	Significant challenge
Deadly	200+ XP	3.0x	Extreme challenge, high risk

KARMA SYSTEM (☯): THE ETHICAL DIMENSION

Karma is perhaps the most important system in WAFT—it represents the ethical dimension of your work and determines your evolution path. Your Karma balance ranges from -100 (High Chaos) to +100 (High Order), and this balance directly influences how your character evolves.

Understanding Karma: More Than Good and Evil

Karma in WAFT isn't about "good" vs "evil"—it's about Order vs Chaos, Structure vs Innovation, Stability vs Disruption. Both paths are valid. Both lead to growth. But they lead to different kinds of growth.

High Order (+50 to +100): The Architect Path. You build structure. You organize. You create systems that are stable, predictable, and maintainable. Your work is about creating order from chaos, establishing patterns, and building foundations. This path leads to bonuses in Intelligence, Armor Class, and Spell Save DC—you become better at logic, defense, and capability effectiveness.

Moderate Order (+10 to +50): The Builder Path. You construct and improve. You work systematically. You focus on building things that work well and last. This is a balanced approach to order—not extreme, but consistent.

Neutral (-10 to +10): The Balanced Path. You don't strongly favor order or chaos. You're flexible, adaptable, versatile. You can work in either direction depending on what's needed. This path doesn't trigger evolution, but it maintains versatility.

Moderate Chaos (-50 to -10): The Disruptor Path. You innovate and experiment. You break things to learn. You challenge existing patterns and try new approaches. This is a balanced approach to chaos—not extreme, but consistently innovative.

High Chaos (-100 to -50): The Glitch Path. You embrace destruction and randomness. You experiment wildly. You break things to see what happens. Your work is about disruption, innovation, and entropy. This path leads to bonuses in Dexterity, Damage, and Evasion—you become better at speed, offense, and avoiding problems.

Karma Sources: Where Your Alignment Comes From

Your Karma comes from the type of work you do and the choices you make:

ORDER Actions (+10 to +20 Karma): Organizing, structuring, helping. When you refactor code to be more organized, create documentation, establish patterns, or help others understand systems, you gain Order Karma. This is the path of the architect—building structure and order.

CHAOS Actions (-10 to -20 Karma): Disrupting, destroying, hacking. When you experiment with new approaches, break things to learn, challenge existing patterns, or try radical solutions, you gain Chaos Karma. This is the path of the innovator—embracing disruption and change.

STABILIZATION (+5 to +15 Karma): Fixing, repairing, stabilizing. When you fix bugs, resolve issues, improve stability, or make systems more reliable, you gain Stabilization Karma. This is moderate Order—not as strong as pure Order, but still structure-focused.

DESTRUCTION (-5 to -15 Karma): Breaking, removing, deleting. When you remove code, delete features, break compatibility, or eliminate things, you gain Destruction Karma. This is moderate Chaos—not as strong as pure Chaos, but still disruption-focused.

Ethical Choices (±10 Karma): User-defined ethical decisions. Sometimes you face choices that aren't clearly Order or Chaos, but have ethical implications. The system allows you to define these and assign Karma accordingly. This gives you control over your ethical alignment.

Karma Calculation: How It Adds Up

Your Karma changes with every ticket you complete:

Base Karma: ±5 per ticket
+ Karma Type Multiplier (ORDER: +10-20, CHAOS: -10-20)
+ Choice-Based Karma (ethical decisions: ±10)
= Total Karma Impact

Example: You complete a ticket where you refactor code to be more organized (ORDER action). You gain:

- Base: +5 Karma
- ORDER Multiplier: +15 Karma
- Total: +20 Karma

Another Example: You complete a ticket where you experiment with a new approach that breaks existing patterns (CHAOS action). You gain:

- Base: -5 Karma
- CHAOS Multiplier: -15 Karma
- Total: -20 Karma

Evolution Paths: Where Karma Leads You

When your Scint pool exceeds 100 and you trigger an evolution check, your Karma balance determines your evolution path:

The Architect Path (High Karma, +50 to +100):

- **Bonuses:** +2 Intelligence, +2 Armor Class, +2 Spell Save DC
- **Abilities:** Structure-based spells, defensive features
- **Focus:** Logic, organization, stability
- **Playstyle:** You become a master of structure. Your code is organized. Your systems are stable. Your capabilities are highly effective. You're the one who builds foundations and creates order.

The Builder Path (Moderate Karma, +10 to +50):

- **Characteristics:** Construction, improvement, systematic work
- **Focus:** Building things that work well and last
- **Playstyle:** You're a reliable builder. You construct things systematically. You improve existing systems. You're consistent and dependable.

Baseline Strain (Neutral Karma, -10 to +10):

- **Characteristics:** Balanced, versatile, stable
- **No specialization:** Flexible, adaptable
- **Playstyle:** You remain versatile. You can work in either direction. You're not specialized, but you're adaptable. This is actually a strength—you can handle any situation.

The Disruptor Path (Moderate Chaos, -50 to -10):

- **Characteristics:** Change, innovation, experimentation
- **Focus:** Challenging patterns, trying new approaches
- **Playstyle:** You're an innovator. You experiment. You try new things. You challenge existing patterns. You're the one who pushes boundaries.

The Glitch Path (High Chaos, -100 to -50):

- **Bonuses:** +2 Dexterity, +2 Damage, +2 Evasion
- **Abilities:** Chaos-based spells, offensive features
- **Focus:** Innovation, disruption, experimentation
- **Playstyle:** You become a master of disruption. You break things to learn. You experiment wildly. Your capabilities are fast and powerful. You're the one who innovates and changes everything.

Strategic Note: Neither path is "better" than the other. The Architect is better at structure and stability. The Glitch is better at innovation and disruption. Choose the path that matches your work style and goals.

Evolution Paths

Evolution Trigger: When Scint Pool > 100, EVOLUTION_CHECK evaluates Karma polarity

The Architect Path (High Karma, Positive):

- **Bonuses:** +2 Intelligence, +2 Armor Class, +2 Spell Save DC
- **Abilities:** Structure-based spells, defensive features
- **Focus:** Logic, organization, stability

The Glitch Path (Low Karma, Negative):

- **Bonuses:** +2 Dexterity, +2 Damage, +2 Evasion
- **Abilities:** Chaos-based spells, offensive features
- **Focus:** Innovation, disruption, experimentation

Baseline Strain (Neutral Karma):

- **Characteristics:** Balanced, versatile, stable
- **No specialization:** Flexible, adaptable

SCINT ECONOMY (✨): THE ENERGY OF CREATION

Scint represents the raw energy of creation—cosmic energy that you accumulate through creative synthesis and problem-solving. Think of it as the "mana" or "energy currency" of the WAFT system. You earn Scint by completing tickets, solving puzzles, stabilizing fractures, and engaging in creative work.

Understanding Scint: The Currency of Growth

Scint is more than just a number—it's a measure of your creative energy and problem-solving capability. When you solve a problem creatively, you're not just solving a problem—you're generating Scint. When you stabilize a fracture (fix an error), you're not just fixing an error—you're converting chaos into order and generating Scint in the process.

Scint Pool: Your accumulated energy, stored by your being. This can range from 0 to unlimited, though typically you'll see values between 0 and 200. The pool represents your potential for growth and evolution.

Scint Sources: You earn Scint from various activities:

- **Ticket Completion:** Base 10 Scint per ticket. This is your steady income.
- **Creative Synthesis:** +5 to +20 Scint for innovative solutions. When you solve a problem in a creative way, you earn bonus Scint.
- **Puzzle Solving:** +10 to +30 Scint for complex problem-solving. When you solve a particularly challenging problem, you earn substantial Scint.
- **Quest Completion:** +20 Scint bonus when you complete an entire quest. This rewards finishing larger efforts.
- **Stabilizing Fractures:** Different types of fractures provide different Scint rewards:
 - SYNTAX_TEAR: +5 Scint (common, formatting errors)
 - LOGIC_FRACTURE: +10 Scint (common, logic fixes)
 - SAFETY_VOID: +15 Scint (rare, safety compliance)
 - HALLUCINATION: +10 Scint (common, fact verification)

Scint Calculation: How You Earn Energy

Your Scint earnings are calculated based on multiple factors:

Base Scint: 10 per ticket

+ Difficulty Multiplier:

- P0_CRITICAL: 3.0x (30 Scint base)
- P1_HIGH: 2.0x (20 Scint base)

- P2_ROUTINE: 1.0x (10 Scint base)
- P3_BACKLOG: 0.5x (5 Scint base)
- + Creative Synthesis Bonus: +5 to +20
- + Puzzle Solving Bonus: +10 to +30
- = Total Scint Bounty

Example: You complete a P1_HIGH ticket with a creative solution:

- Base: 10 Scint
- Difficulty Multiplier: 2.0x = 20 Scint
- Creative Synthesis: +15 Scint
- Total: 35 Scint

Another Example: You complete a P0_CRITICAL ticket that required complex problem-solving:

- Base: 10 Scint
- Difficulty Multiplier: 3.0x = 30 Scint
- Puzzle Solving: +25 Scint
- Total: 55 Scint

Scint Costs: How You Spend Energy

Scint isn't just accumulated—it's also spent. Every action has a cost:

Cast Cantrip (0 Scint): Free, unlimited use. Your basic tools cost nothing.

Cast 1st Level Spell (5 Scint): Low cost, common use. Your standard capabilities are affordable.

Cast 2nd Level Spell (10 Scint): Moderate cost. Use these when you need more power.

Cast 3rd Level Spell (20 Scint): High cost, powerful. Use these strategically.

System Repair/Healing (10 Scint): Restore HP when you're damaged. Use this when you need to recover from challenges.

Spawn Variant (20 Scint): Create a new variant of yourself. This is advanced—creating parallel versions for experimentation.

Evolve Genome (50 Scint): Adopt a better genome. This is significant evolution—changing your fundamental nature.

Evolution Trigger (100 Scint): The big one. When your Scint pool exceeds 100, you can trigger evolution. This consumes 100 Scint and potentially transforms your character based on your Karma balance.

Scint Management Strategies

Managing your Scint pool is a strategic game. You have several approaches:

Conservative Strategy: Save Scint for evolution. Focus on accumulating energy without spending it. This approach gets you to evolution faster, but you're less effective in the short term because you're not using your capabilities as much.

Aggressive Strategy: Spend Scint on spells and abilities immediately. Use your capabilities freely to solve problems now. This approach makes you more effective immediately, but it delays evolution because you're spending energy instead of saving it.

Balanced Strategy: Mix of saving and spending. Save Scint when you're close to evolution (80+), spend it when you need capabilities. This approach balances immediate effectiveness with long-term growth.

Specialized Strategy: Focus on specific abilities. Spend Scint on spells that match your playstyle and goals. This approach optimizes for your preferred way of working.

Strategic Note: There's no "right" strategy. It depends on your goals, your current situation, and your playstyle. Experiment and find what works for you.

Evolution Trigger: The Moment of Transformation

When your Scint pool exceeds 100, something special happens. The system evaluates your Karma balance and determines your evolution path:

- Evolution Process:**
- 1. Scint Pool > 100 (you've accumulated enough energy)
 - 2. EVOLUTION_CHECK triggered (the system evaluates your state)
 - 3. Evaluate Karma Balance:
 - High Karma (positive) → The Architect
 - Low Karma (negative) → The Glitch
 - Neutral Karma → Baseline (no evolution)
 - 4. Apply Genetic Mutation:
 - Update current_strain (your evolution path)
 - Apply evolution bonuses (stat increases, new abilities)
 - Update mutation_progress (track your growth)
 - 5. Reset Scint Pool (evolution consumes 100 Scint)
 - 6. Record Evolution Event (your transformation is logged)

Evolution Outcomes:

Karma Balance	Evolution Path	Mutation Type	Scint Consumed
+50 to +100	The Architect	Order/Structure	100
+10 to +50	The Builder	Moderate Order	100
-10 to +10	Baseline	No evolution	0 (no trigger)
-50 to -10	The Disruptor	Moderate Chaos	100
-100 to -50	The Glitch	Chaos/Entropy	100

Important: Evolution is a major milestone. It transforms your character, but it also resets your Scint pool. This means you need to accumulate energy again for the next evolution. Evolution is a cycle—accumulate, evolve, repeat.

Evolution Trigger

Evolution Check: Triggered when `scint_pool > 100`

Evolution Process:

- 1. Scint Pool > 100
- 2. EVOLUTION_CHECK triggered
- 3. Evaluate Karma Balance:
 - High Karma (positive) → The Architect
 - Low Karma (negative) → The Glitch
 - Neutral Karma → Baseline (no evolution)
- 4. Apply Genetic Mutation:
 - Update `current_strain`
 - Apply evolution bonuses
 - Update `mutation_progress`
- 5. Reset Scint Pool (evolution consumes Scint)
- 6. Record Evolution Event

Evolution Outcomes:

Karma Balance	Evolution Path	Mutation Type	Scint Consumed
+50 to +100	The Architect	Order/Structure	100
+10 to +50	The Builder	Moderate Order	100
-10 to +10	Baseline	No evolution	0 (no trigger)
-50 to -10	The Disruptor	Moderate Chaos	100
-100 to -50	The Glitch	Chaos/Entropy	100

NAMING STRUCTURES

_pyrite Ticket Naming

Format: PY- [CYCLE] - [ID]

Examples:

- PY-001-A: First ticket in cycle 1
- PY-001-B: Second ticket in cycle 1
- PY-005-C: Third ticket in cycle 5
- PY-042-Z: 26th ticket in cycle 42

Being ID Naming

Format: being_[TIMESTAMP]_[HASH]

Examples:

- being_20260112_143904_a1b2c3d4
- being_20260112_150123_b2c3d4e5

Scientific Naming (Taxonomy)

Format: "Genus Species, Title"

Examples:

- Cognis Novus, the Fragile (Latin culture)
- Prana Adi, the Swift (Sanskrit culture)
- Fenris Fyrsti, the Great (Old Norse culture)
- Aura Alpha, the Bold (Cyber/Tech culture)

Naming Cultures:

Culture	Genome ID Range	Philosophy	Example Genera
Sanskrit (Vedic)	0x00-0x3F	Spiritual, metaphysical	Prana, Akasha, Karma
Old Norse	0x40-0x7F	Heroic, warrior	Fenris, Odin, Thor
Latin	0x80-0xBF	Classical, scholarly	Cognis, Aura, Mens
Cyber/Tech	0xC0-0xFF	Modern, technological	Aura, Nexus, Data

GAME FLOW

Complete D&D & Karma Flow

1. Work Effort Created
- ↓
2. Opt-in to Quest (manual)
- ↓
3. QuestGenerator Creates _pyrite Tickets (PY-[CYCLE]-[ID])
- ↓
4. Tickets Assigned to UNIT_GENESIS Being
- ↓
5. Being Completes Ticket (D&D encounter)
- ↓
6. ChallengeSystem Calculates Rewards:

- XP (D&D 5e)
 - Scint (🔥)
 - Karma (🌀)
 - Items/Loot
- ↓
7. Being State Updated:
- HP, AC, Spell Slots
 - Scint Pool
 - Karma Balance
 - Level, XP
- ↓
8. Evolution Check:
- IF Scint > 100:
 - Evaluate Karma Balance
 - Trigger Evolution (Architect/Glitch)
 - Apply Genetic Mutations
 - Reset Scint Pool
- ↓
9. Hair HMI Updated (Blue/Violet/White/Gold/Red)
- ↓
10. Event Logged to Flight Recorder
- ↓
11. Cycle Repeats

QUICK REFERENCE

Karma Types

Type	Description	Typical Actions	Karma Impact
ORDER	Organizing, structuring	Refactoring, organizing code	+10 to +20
CHAOS	Disrupting, destroying	Breaking things, experiments	-10 to -20
STABILIZATION	Fixing, repairing	Bug fixes, stability work	+5 to +15
DESTRUCTION	Breaking, removing	Deletions, removals	-5 to -15

Ethical Choice Examples

Choice	Karma Impact	Implication
Delete vs. Archive	-10 vs. +10	Destruction vs. Order

Choice	Karma Impact	Implication
Quick Fix vs. Proper Solution	-5 vs. +15	Chaos vs. Stabilization
Break Compatibility vs. Maintain	-20 vs. +20	Destruction vs. Order
Experiment vs. Follow Standards	-10 vs. +10	Chaos vs. Order

Scint Management Strategies

Strategy	Description	Use Case
Conservative	Save for evolution	Long-term growth
Aggressive	Spend on spells/abilities	Immediate power
Balanced	Mix of saving and spending	General purpose
Specialized	Focus on specific abilities	Role specialization

BEST PRACTICES

Karma Management

- **Balance Order and Chaos:** Mix ORDER and CHAOS tickets to maintain balance
- **Consider Long-term Goals:** Think about evolution goals when making choices
- **Use STABILIZATION:** Offset DESTRUCTION with STABILIZATION work
- **Track Regularly:** Monitor Karma balance to guide evolution path

Scint Management

- **Evolution Planning:** Save Scint for evolution when close to threshold (80+)
- **Resource Optimization:** Use low-cost spells (cantrips) when possible
- **Strategic Spending:** Balance immediate power with long-term growth
- **Track Accumulation:** Monitor Scint accumulation rate

Character Development

- **Role Specialization:** Choose evolution path based on play style
- **Versatility:** Maintain balanced stats for flexibility
- **Skill Development:** Learn diverse spells for different situations

- **Build Character:** Develop character around chosen path

CONCLUSION: YOUR JOURNEY FORWARD

You've now read the complete WAFT Game Rules. You understand the mechanics, the systems, and the flow. But understanding is just the beginning. The real magic happens when you start using the system, when you see your work reflected in your character's growth, when you experience evolution.

The Core Philosophy: Why This Matters

"Every action has consequences. Every choice shapes destiny."

This isn't just a tagline—it's the fundamental truth of WAFT. The system creates a feedback loop between your work and your character. When you see your character evolve based on the work you do, it makes that work feel more meaningful. You're not just completing tasks—you're shaping your destiny.

The Three Pillars: What Makes WAFT Work

Ethical Agency: Your choices matter. The Karma system tracks your ethical alignment and reflects it in your evolution. You have agency over your path.

Evolutionary Ethics: Your character development is guided by ethical frameworks. The system doesn't judge Order vs Chaos—both are valid. But it does reflect your choices back to you.

Cosmic Energy: Your work generates Scint—the energy of creation. This energy powers your capabilities and triggers your evolution. Your work literally becomes energy.

Digital Identity: Your character has a unique scientific name based on your genetic code. You're not just a developer—you're a being with identity.

Reincarnation: Your consciousness continues across lifetimes. When you evolve, you transform, but you remain. Your history is preserved.

Practical Guidance: How to Use WAFT

Start Small: Don't try to understand everything at once. Start with the basics—complete tickets, earn rewards, watch your character grow.

Pay Attention: Notice how your work affects your Karma. Notice how your Scint accumulates. Notice how your character evolves. The system is giving you feedback.

Make Choices: You have agency. Choose your path. Embrace Order or Chaos. Or stay balanced. The choice is yours.

Experiment: Try different approaches. See what works for you. The system rewards experimentation.

Evolve: When you reach the evolution threshold, embrace it. Evolution is transformation. It's growth. It's the point of the system.

The Journey Ahead

Your journey with WAFT is just beginning. Every ticket you complete is an encounter. Every quest you finish is an adventure. Every evolution is a transformation. The system is designed to make your work feel meaningful and connected to a larger narrative.

Remember: You're not just a developer. You're a Warforged Wizard. You're a being that evolves through work. You're part of a system that tracks your growth, rewards your creativity, and reflects your choices.

Happy adventuring, and may your Scint pool overflow with cosmic energy!

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